Research Note 1: The Cost of Procrastination

Project context

Our Professional Skills group presentation focuses on **Time Management & Productivity**. My contribution covers the consequences of procrastination and practical tools for getting started. This first note focuses on the research behind the consequences.

Research findings

Tice and Baumeister (1997) examined student procrastination in two longitudinal studies. Students who procrastinated initially reported less stress and illness. Near the end of the semester, however, they reported more stress and illness and received lower grades.

The main takeaway is that the immediate relief of postponing work can come with later costs. These findings show associations rather than proving that procrastination alone causes poor health or lower grades.

Example for the presentation

Imagine leaving a group presentation until the night before the deadline. There is less time to check sources, improve the slides and rehearse together. This example connects the research to a familiar student experience.

Presentation approach

Use the study as a brief research foundation, then explain the idea through the group-work example. A later note will cover the Two-Minute Rule and the Pomodoro Technique.

References

- Tice, D. M., & Baumeister, R. F. (1997). *Longitudinal study of procrastination, performance, stress, and health: The costs and benefits of dawdling*. Psychological Science, 8(6), 454–458. Article abstract and DOI.
- Jaffe, E. (2013). *Why Wait? The Science Behind Procrastination*. Association for Psychological Science. Research overview.